ranks number one in the raw jute and jute goods production and number two in export of jute goods in the world.

3. Cotton and textile industry

- Oldest industry of India, and employs largest number of workers.
- It is the largest organised and broad-based industry which accounts for 4% of GDP, 20% of manufacturing value-added and one third of total export earnings.
- The first Indian modernised cotton cloth mill was established in 1818 at Fort Gloaster near Calcutta. But this mill was not successful. The second mill named "Mumbai's Spinning and Weaving Co." was established in 1854 at Bombay by KGN Daber.

4. Sugar industry

- Sugar industry is the second largest industry among agriculture-based industries in India.
- India is now the largest producer and consumer of sugar in the world. Maharashtra contributes over one third of the Indian total sugar output, followed closely by Uttar Pradesh.

5. Fertiliser industry

- India is the third largest producer of nitrogenous fertilisers in the world.

6. Paper industry

- The first mechanised paper mill was set up in 1812 at Serampur in West Bengal.
- The paper industry in India is ranked among the 15 top global paper industries.

7. Silk industry

- India is the second-largest(first being China) country in the world in producing natural silk. At present, India produces about 16% silk of the world.
- India enjoys the distinction of being the only country producing all the five known commercial varieties of silk viz Mulberry, Tropical Tussar, Oak Tussar, Eri and Muga.

8. Petroleum and natural gas

- First successful Oilwell was dug in India in 1889 at Digboi, Assam.
- At present a number of regions with oil reserves have been identified and oil is being extracted in these regions
- For exploration purpose, Oil and Natural Gas Commission (ONGC) was established in 1956 at Dehradun, Uttarakhand

8.9 Small Scale Industries

Small scale industries play an important role for the development of Indian economy in many ways. About 60 to 70 percent of the total innovations in India comes from the SSIs. Many of the big businesses today were all started small and then nurtured into big businesses. The role of SSIs in economic development of the country is briefly explained in the forthcoming paragraphs.

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